MODULE 2 · PROCEDURES AND PRACTICE

Lesson 04: Reverting to Voice, Phraseology and Failures

Lesson 4 of 6 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Recognise when to revert from CPDLC to voice.
- Use CPDLC-related voice phraseology.
- Handle message failures and CPDLC system failures.



When in doubt, revert to voice.

When to revert to voice

- To clarify an unexpected, inappropriate or ambiguous CPDLC message.
- To make sure an instruction is executed in time.
- To correct an unintended message that has been sent.
- When a time-out or an error occurs for a CPDLC message.
- Always for urgent or emergency situations.

Phraseology

Situation	Phraseology
Correcting a CPDLC message by voice	"(call sign) DISREGARD CPDLC (message content or type) MESSAGE, BREAK, (corrected message)" Example: "DOMESTIC 3012, DISREGARD CPDLC CLIMB MESSAGE, BREAK, CLIMB FLIGHT LEVEL 360."
Failure of a single message	Confirm by voice the action that will be taken, prefaced with "CPDLC MESSAGE FAILURE" — or resend the message by CPDLC.

CPDLC has failed	Revert to voice and inform the other party: “CPDLC FAILURE”.
Complete ground system failure	Controller: “ALL STATIONS CPDLC FAILURE (unit name)”.
Stop sending requests	“((call sign) or ALL STATIONS) STOP SENDING CPDLC REQUESTS [UNTIL ADVISED] [(reason)]”
Resume normal use	“((call sign) or ALL STATIONS) RESUME NORMAL CPDLC OPERATIONS”

GOOD PRACTICE

Keep listening to the voice frequency at all times while using CPDLC. A clearance received by voice takes precedence over a pending CPDLC message on the same subject — clarify if in doubt.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Revert to voice to clarify, to ensure timely execution, to correct, after a time-out or error, and always in an emergency.
- Use “DISREGARD CPDLC … MESSAGE, BREAK …”, “CPDLC MESSAGE FAILURE”, “CPDLC FAILURE”.
- Keep a listening watch on voice.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

A CPDLC message times out without a response. What should you do?

A. Send it again repeatedly

B. Revert to voice to confirm the clearance

C. Ignore it

D. Switch off the CMU

Answer: B. After a time-out or error, revert to voice.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.